



## ABOUT OUR FESTIVAL

The Haudenosaunee are the originators and keepers of the game known today as "lacrosse." Deyhontsigwa'ehs goes back millennia and is also known as "The Creator's Game" and the "Medicine Game." We are dedicated and committed to re-establishing a Haudenosaunee presence here at Onondaga Lake, where Deyhontsigwa'ehs was originally played.

## CONTACT INFO

✉ [aila@aila.ngo](mailto:aila@aila.ngo)

🌐 [www.aila.ngo](http://www.aila.ngo)

📍 305 Vine Street Ste. 3, Liverpool, NY 13088

2026

# HAUDENOSAUNEE WOODEN STICK FESTIVAL

Restore Our Sacred Lake 5K  
Smoke Dancing Competition  
Rand Hall Memorial Masters Tournament

# SATURDAY SCHEDULE

**8:00 AM - RESTORE OUR SACRED LAKE 5K**

**10:00 AM - FESTIVAL OPENING**

EMCEE HEATH HILL  
RANDY HALL TOURNAMENT BEGINS ON THE FIELD  
BETTY (LYONS) HILL WELCOME

**11 AM - ONONDAGA LAKE**

EMCEE HEATH HILL  
MAIN TENT SPEAKER JAKE EDWARDS:  
THE IMPORTANCE OF ONONDAGA LAKE AND THE  
FORMATION OF THE  
HAUDENOSAUNEE CONFEDERACY

**NOON - STICK MAKING DEMONSTRATION**

EMCEE HEATH HILL  
MAIN TENT SPEAKER  
TRAVIS GABRIEL WOODEN STICK LACROSSE  
MAKING DEMONSTRATION

**1-3 PM - HAUDENOSAUNEE TREATIES**

EMCEE HEATH HILL  
MAIN TENT SPEAKER  
ONONDAGA ELDER JAKE EDWARDS  
TREATY BELTS

# SATURDAY SCHEDULE

**3PM - KATYOHKWA**

EEMCEE HEATH HILL  
KATYOHKWA (PEOPLE/GROUP )  
HAUDENOSAUNEE CULTURE AND SOCIAL DANCES  
LEAD BY HEATH HILL  
SINGER ALAN DOWDY

**4PM - SMOKE DANCE COMPETITION**

EMCEE HEATH HILL  
SMOKE DANCE COMPETITION

**ChuckleBerries**   
*Self-Serve Yogurt And More!*

# SUNDAY SCHEDULE

## 10:00 AM - TOURNAMENT DAY 2

EMCEE HEATH HILL  
BEGINNING OF DAY 2: RANDY HALL TOURNAMENT  
Onondaga Lake Ceanup

## 11 AM SNOWSNAKE DEMONSTRATION

EMCEE HEATH HILL  
MAIN TENT SPEAKER  
ED SHENANDOAH

## 11:30 - WOMENS MOVEMENT

EMCEE HEATH HILL  
MAIN TENT SPEAKER  
CIARRAI EATON GAGE FOUNDATION

## NOON - WOODEN STICK DEMONSTRATION

EEMCEE HEATH HILL  
MAIN TENT SPEAKER  
TRAVIS GABRIEL TRADITIONAL WOODEN LACROSSE  
STICK MAKING DEMONSTRATION

# SUNDAY SCHEDULE

## 1PM - HAUDENOSAUNEE NATIONALS

EMCEE HEATH HILL  
MAIN TENT SPEAKER  
REX LYONS  
2028 BID FOR THE OLYMPICS  
SOVEREIGNTY AND OUR RIGHT  
TO PLAY UNDER OUR OWN FLAG

## 2PM LAKEBACK EFFORTS, MAPLE BAY

EMCEE HEATH HILL  
MAIN TENT SPEAKER  
JEANNE SHENANDOAH JOE HEATH

## 3PM IMPORTANCE OF ONONDAGA LAKE

MAIN TENT SPEAKERS  
ROBERT ABBOTT  
TINA HILL

# SUNDAY SCHEDULE

## 4PM - ALLY AWARD PRESENTATION

EMCEE HEATH HILL

MAIN TENT SPEAKER

BETTY LYONS

PRESENTATION OF THE AMERICAN INDIAN LAW  
ALLIANCE ALLY AWARD &

## 4:30 - KATYOHKWA

EMCEE HEATH HILL

KATYOHKWA (PEOPLE/GROUP)

HAUDENOSAUNEE

CULTURE AND SOCIAL DANCES

LEAD BY HEATH HILL

SINGER ALAN DOWDY

## 5:30 - TOURNAMENT AWARDS

EMCEE HEATH HILL

RANDY HALL MASTERS MEMORIAL WOODEN STICK  
LACROSSE TOURNAMENT AWARDS

TRADITIONAL CLOSING HEATH HILL





Native American Community Services (NACS) is a non-profit organization founded in 1975 to provide quality health and social services to the off-reservation Native American population in Erie and Niagara Counties. In keeping with our "Tradition of Caring," we have since grown into a full-scale human services agency committed to helping the entire community.

[www.nacswny.org](http://www.nacswny.org)

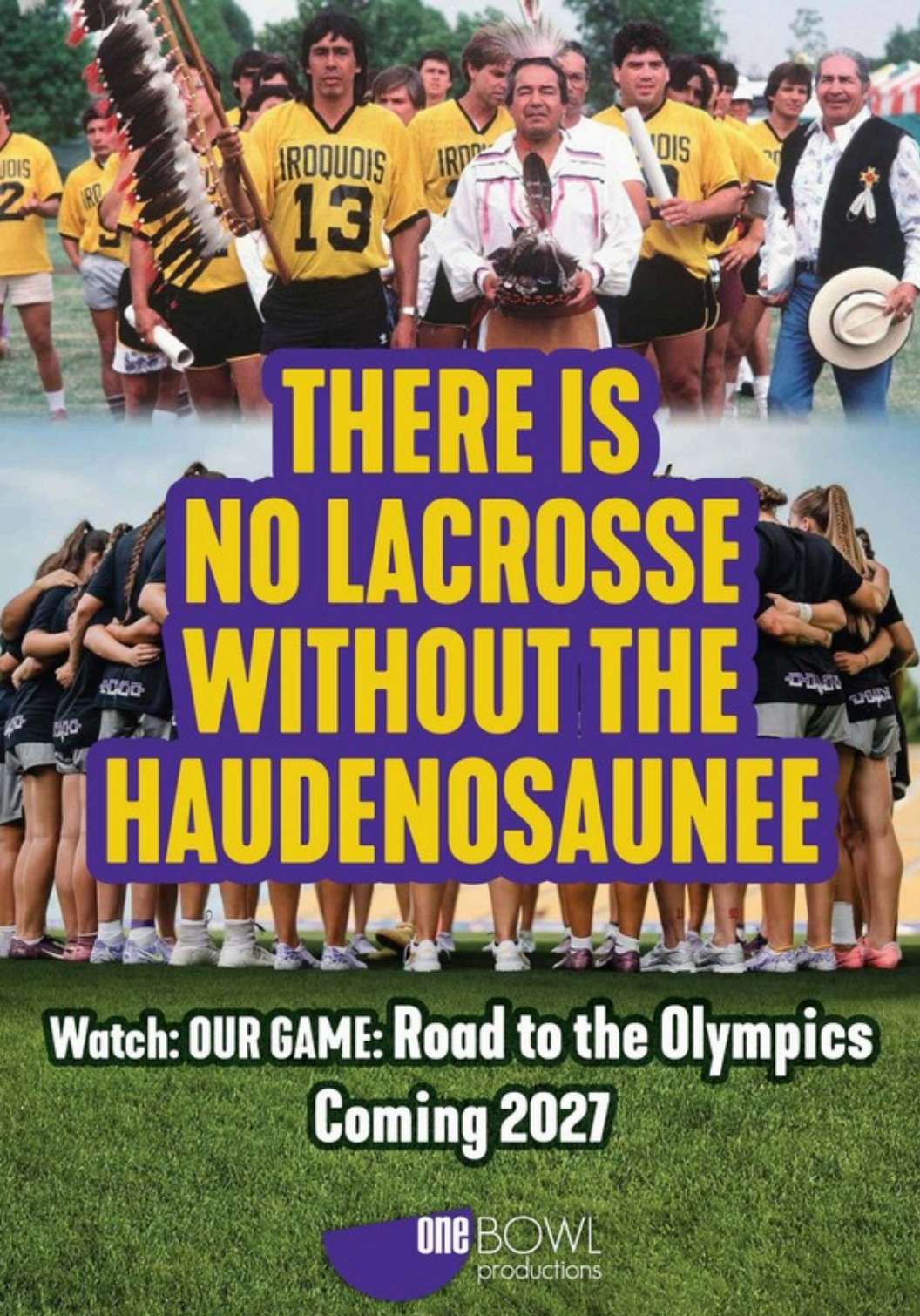
## RANDY HALL MEMORIAL MASTERS LACROSSE TOURNAMENT TEAMS

1. **Oneida Silverhawks** - Oneida/Onondaga (Team Manager - Gilbert Stout)
2. **Team United** - Philadelphia (Team Manager - Shawn Langen)
3. **Kanesatake Masters** - (Team Manager - Brandon Etienne)
4. **Onondaga Redhawks** - (Team Manager - Junior Bucktooth)
5. **Mann's Wolfpack** - Akwesasne (Team Manager - Mickey Waulkey)

### Referees:

1. Percy Shenandoah
2. Mike Hopper
3. Carson Colucci





# THERE IS NO LACROSSE WITHOUT THE HAUDENOSAUNEE

**Watch: OUR GAME: Road to the Olympics**  
**Coming 2027**



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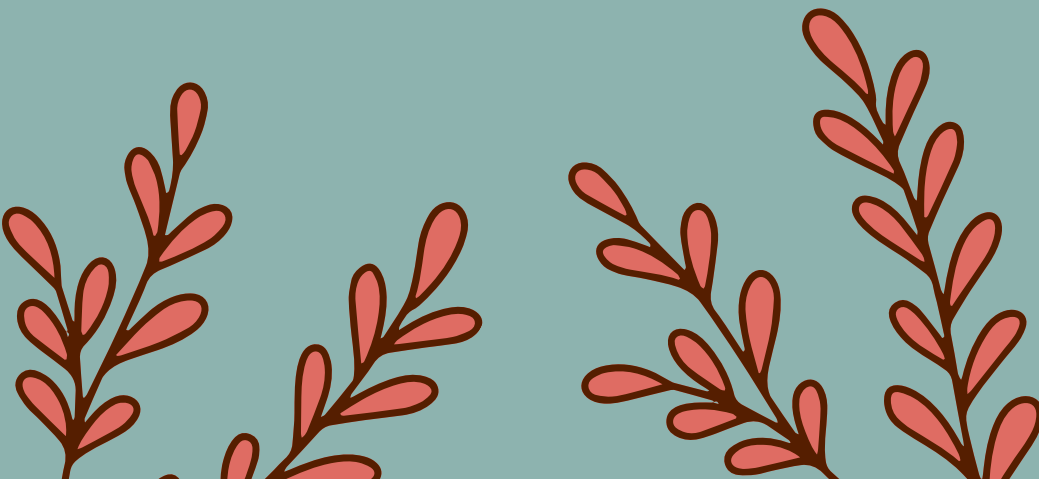
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The Haudenosaunee Nationals Lacrosse Organization is an Indigenous sports organization (the only one of its kind in the world) that competes on the world stage. We are sanctioned by the sovereign Haudenosaunee Grand Council and are governed by the Haudenosaunee Nationals Board of Directors. The Haudenosaunee Nationals Development Group (HNDG) is the fiscal and legal arm of the Haudenosaunee Nationals.



## A SPECIAL THANK YOU MESSAGE

In 2013, Randy Hall (Mohawk Nation) brought a leather ball to Philip P. Arnold and Sandy Bigtree (Mohawk Nation) and asked them for help in bringing Deyhontsigwa'ehs (They Bump Hips) back to its place of origin here at Onondaga Lake. After that meeting, Arnold and Bigtree and their non-profit Indigenous Values Initiative organized the inaugural Haudenosaunee Wooden Stick Festival, which was held at Onondaga Lake in 2013. Since that time, the American Indian Law Alliance collaborated with the Indigenous Values Initiative on co-hosting and coordinating the events of this weekend. At the start of 2024, Arnold and Bigtree have asked to take a break from the festival to spend more time with their sons and to finally take a vacation and relax! The American Indian Law Alliance said yes, of course, we were happy to take it on and run the festival solo, and give them a much-needed time of rest and relaxation. This is all possible thanks to our incredible team of volunteers and returning vendors and teams. A huge NYA•WEÑHA to Phil Arnold, Sandy Bigtree, and all of our volunteers and staff who make this a great event. Last but not least thank you to the staff of Onondaga County Parks.

## RETURN OF MAPLE BAY

Heal the Reciprocal Relationship Between the Lake and Onondaga Nation #Lakeback

Onondaga Lake is the birthplace of democracy, lacrosse, the women's rights movement, and more. This lake is the ancestral home of the Onondaga Nation and the Haudenosaunee Confederacy. The United States agreed that the lake would always belong to the Onondaga Nation and the Haudenosaunee Confederacy with the 1794 Canandaigua treaty.

[lakeback.org](https://lakeback.org) >>

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## Patagonia

### Action

### Works

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FOUNDATION



NATIONAL  
INSTITUTE  
FOR LAW &  
JUSTICE

# HAUDENOSAUNEE WOODEN STICK FESTIVAL

Thank you to our vendors, sponsors,  
speakers and teams for making this  
weekend a success.



HONOR  
THE EARTH

